

25 prompts to build and scale your freelance business

25
PROMPTS

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Freelancing

Works with: **ChatGPT • Claude • Gemini • Llama**

About This Playbook

25 expert prompts for freelancers covering client acquisition, proposals, pricing, project management, and scaling to an agency.

What You'll Get

• 25 expert prompts • Professional frameworks • Placeholder system • Expert tips per prompt

Who It's For

• Entrepreneurs • Professionals • Teams • Freelancers

How to Use This Playbook

- 1 Copy the prompt — Select the full prompt text from the section that matches your goal.
- 2 Fill in the brackets — Replace all [PLACEHOLDER] text with your specific context, brand, or product.
- 3 Paste & generate — Paste into ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini, or your preferred AI tool.
- 4 Iterate — Use the output as a starting point. Refine with follow-up prompts for best results.

Table of Contents

Section 1 — Section 1 (5 prompts)

- #01 Freelance Niche Selection
- #02 Cold Outreach Email for Freelancers
- #03 Freelance Proposal Template
- #04 Freelance Pricing Strategy
- #05 Client Discovery Call Script

Section 2 — Section 2 (5 prompts)

- #06 Freelance Contract Template
- #07 Invoice and Payment System
- #08 Portfolio Creation Guide
- #09 Referral System for Freelancers
- #10 Retainer Offer Design

Section 3 — Section 3 (5 prompts)

- #11 Client Onboarding Process
- #12 Scope Creep Prevention System
- #13 Freelance Rate Calculator
- #14 Agency Transition Plan
- #15 Testimonial Generation System

Section 4 — Section 4 (5 prompts)

- #16 Freelance Niche Package Offers
- #17 LinkedIn Profile for Freelancers
- #18 Raise Your Rates Email
- #19 Client Feedback System
- #20 Content Strategy for Freelancer Authority

Section 5 — Section 5 (5 prompts)

- #21 Partnership and Subcontractor Network
- #22 Discovery to Close: Full Sales Process
- #23 Passive Income for Freelancers
- #24 Working with Agencies as Subcontractor
- #25 Freelance Business Systems Audit

Section 1

Section 1 (5 prompts)

Prompt #01

Freelance Niche Selection

Find the most profitable niche for [FREELANCER] with skills in [SKILL]

You are a freelance positioning specialist. Find the most profitable niche for [FREELANCER] with skills in [SKILL SET]. Deliver: 1. Skills inventory → market demand mapping 2. Top 5 niche candidates with revenue potential 3. Competition analysis per niche 4. Ideal client profile for top niche 5. Positioning statement

Placeholders: [FREELANCER] Your background [SKILL SET] Your skills

■ **Tip:** The best freelance niche is: your skills + high-paying clients + a problem you can solve repeatedly.

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Prompt #02

Cold Outreach Email for Freelancers

Write cold outreach templates for [FREELANCER] targeting [CLIENT TYPE]

You are a freelance sales specialist. Write cold outreach templates for [FREELANCER] targeting [CLIENT TYPE]. Deliver: Template 1: Research-led (specific insight about their business) Template 2: Problem-led (you spotted an issue) Template 3: Results-led (here's what I did for a similar company) Follow-up sequence (3 emails)

Placeholders: [FREELANCER] Your specialty [CLIENT TYPE] Target client

■ **Tip:** Freelance outreach that mentions a specific problem you spotted about THEIR business has 5x higher reply rates.

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Prompt #03

Freelance Proposal Template

Write a winning freelance proposal for [PROJECT TYPE] for a [CLIENT TYPE]

You are a proposal writing specialist. Write a winning freelance proposal for [PROJECT TYPE] for a [CLIENT TYPE]. Deliver: 1. Executive summary (their problem + your solution) 2. Scope of work (specific deliverables) 3. Timeline (milestone-based) 4. Investment (pricing, payment terms) 5. About you (credibility, not resume) 6. Next steps (single action) 7. Testimonial

Placeholders: [PROJECT TYPE] Type of project [CLIENT TYPE] Client type

■ **Tip:** Proposals that start with the client's problem win more often than those that start with your capabilities.

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Prompt #04

Freelance Pricing Strategy

Create a pricing strategy for [FREELANCER SPECIALTY] at [EXPERIENCE LE

You are a freelance pricing consultant. Create a pricing strategy for [FREELANCER SPECIALTY] at [EXPERIENCE LEVEL]. Deliver: 1. Market rate research methodology 2. Value-based pricing calculation 3. Package pricing design (3 tiers) 4. Hourly vs project vs retainer comparison 5. When to raise rates 6. How to present prices without discounting

Placeholders: [FREELANCER SPECIALTY] Your service [EXPERIENCE LEVEL] Junior/mid/senior

■ **Tip:** Most freelancers underprice by 40%. The first test: raise rates 30% on your next proposal.

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Prompt #05

Client Discovery Call Script

Write a discovery call script for [FREELANCER] with a potential new cl

You are a client acquisition specialist. Write a discovery call script for [FREELANCER] with a potential new client. Deliver: 1. Rapport building (2-3 questions) 2. Problem exploration (4-5 questions) 3. Current situation and solutions tried 4. Ideal outcome definition 5. Budget and timeline discovery 6. Next steps close + What NOT to do on a discovery call

■ **Tip:** The discovery call is won by the freelancer who listens most. Your job is to understand, not pitch.

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Section 2

Section 2 (5 prompts)

Prompt #06

Freelance Contract Template

Write a freelance services contract for [SERVICE TYPE].

You are a contracts specialist. Write a freelance services contract for [SERVICE TYPE]. Deliver: Sections: Services, Timeline, Payment (including late fee), Intellectual property, Revisions limit, Kill fee, Confidentiality, Non-solicitation, Dispute resolution + Scope creep clause + Kill fee explanation

Placeholders: [SERVICE TYPE] Type of freelance service

■ **Tip:** Kill fee and revision limit clauses prevent the most common freelance disasters.

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Prompt #07

Invoice and Payment System

Build an invoicing and payment system for [FREELANCER] to get paid on

You are a freelance operations specialist. Build an invoicing and payment system for [FREELANCER] to get paid on time. Deliver: 1. Invoice template (professional, clear) 2. Payment schedule design (50% upfront) 3. Payment reminder sequence (before and after due date) 4. Late payment process (reminder → final notice → collection) 5. Tools recommendation

■ **Tip:** *Never start work without a deposit. 50% upfront protects you and creates client commitment.*

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Claude ✓

Gemini ✓

Prompt #08

Portfolio Creation Guide

Create a portfolio strategy for [FREELANCER] in [NICHE].

You are a freelance branding specialist. Create a portfolio strategy for [FREELANCER] in [NICHE]. Deliver: 1. Portfolio platform selection 2. Case study format (problem → approach → result) 3. Which projects to include (and exclude) 4. How to create portfolio pieces before you have clients 5. Testimonial placement strategy

Placeholders: [FREELANCER] Your specialty [NICHE] Your market

■ **Tip:** *A portfolio without case studies is just a gallery. Show the thinking, not just the output.*

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Claude ✓

Gemini ✓

Prompt #09

Referral System for Freelancers

Build a referral system for [FREELANCER] to generate consistent inbound

You are a referral growth specialist. Build a referral system for [FREELANCER] to generate consistent inbound leads. Deliver: 1. Who to ask and when (timing is everything) 2. How to ask without feeling awkward 3. Referral incentive design 4. Partner referral program 5. LinkedIn recommendation strategy 6. Monthly referral outreach cadence

■ **Tip:** *Timing the referral ask correctly (right after a client win) doubles response rates.*

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Prompt #10

Retainer Offer Design

Design a retainer offering for [FREELANCER] to create predictable mont

You are a retainer sales specialist. Design a retainer offering for [FREELANCER] to create predictable monthly income. Deliver: 1. Services that work as retainers 2. Retainer pricing model (fixed vs variable) 3. Scope definition (what's included and what isn't) 4. Transition from project to retainer pitch 5. Retainer agreement terms

■ **Tip:** Retainers create financial stability. Converting 3 clients to retainers can replace 10 one-off projects.

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Section 3

Section 3 (5 prompts)

Prompt #11

Client Onboarding Process

Design a client onboarding process for [FREELANCER]'s business.

You are a freelance operations coach. Design a client onboarding process for [FREELANCER]'s business. Deliver: 1. Welcome package content 2. Kickoff call agenda 3. Tools and access setup 4. Communication norms agreement 5. First week touchpoints 6. Success metrics agreement

■ **Tip:** Great onboarding creates the 'wow' that generates referrals.

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Prompt #12

Scope Creep Prevention System

Build a scope creep prevention system for [FREELANCER].

You are a project management specialist. Build a scope creep prevention system for [FREELANCER]. Deliver: 1. Project scope definition in contracts 2. Change request process 3. Change order template (additional cost approval) 4. How to have the 'that's out of scope' conversation 5. Revisiting scope at milestones

■ **Tip:** Scope creep is the #1 profit killer in freelancing. Build the fence before the clients push it.

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Prompt #13

Freelance Rate Calculator

Build a rate calculation framework for [FREELANCER] to price profitabl

You are a financial planning specialist. Build a rate calculation framework for [FREELANCER] to price profitably. Deliver: 1. Desired annual income 2. Billable hours calculation (actual vs theoretical) 3. Business expense budget 4. Desired profit margin 5. Calculated minimum hourly rate 6. Adjustment for value delivered

■ **Tip:** Most freelancers calculate rates wrong because they forget non-billable time. Factor it in.

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Prompt #14

Agency Transition Plan

Create a plan for [FREELANCER] to transition from solo to agency.

You are a freelance scaling coach. Create a plan for [FREELANCER] to transition from solo to agency. Deliver: 1. When to hire (revenue threshold + demand signals) 2. First hire: Subcontractor vs employee 3. Who to hire first (complementary skill set) 4. Systemizing delivery before scaling 5. Pricing adjustment for overhead

■ **Tip:** Don't hire until you have more work than you can deliver. Hiring too early kills the business.

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Prompt #15

Testimonial Generation System

Build a testimonial generation system for [FREELANCER].

You are a freelance marketing specialist. Build a testimonial generation system for [FREELANCER]. Deliver: 1. Timing the ask (day of project completion or first result) 2. Questions that generate compelling testimonials 3. Video vs text vs LinkedIn recommendation strategy 4. Where to use testimonials 5. Quarterly testimonial audit

■ **Tip:** Ask for testimonials immediately at project completion. Waiting even a week drops quality dramatically.

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Section 4

Section 4 (5 prompts)

Prompt #16

Freelance Niche Package Offers

Design 3 productized service packages for [FREELANCER] in [NICHE].

You are a productized services specialist. Design 3 productized service packages for [FREELANCER] in [NICHE]. Deliver: Package 1: Starter (quick win, lower price point) Package 2: Core (primary offer, best value) Package 3: Premium (full service, highest outcome) For each: Deliverables, timeline, price, ideal client

Placeholders: [FREELANCER] Your specialty [NICHE] Your market

■ **Tip:** Productized services eliminate scope ambiguity and make it easy for clients to say yes.

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Prompt #17

LinkedIn Profile for Freelancers

Optimize [FREELANCER]'s LinkedIn profile to attract inbound client inquiries

You are a freelance lead generation specialist. Optimize [FREELANCER]'s LinkedIn profile to attract inbound client inquiries. Deliver: 1. Headline (who you help + the result, not 'freelancer') 2. About section (first 3 lines – the hook) 3. Featured section (portfolio + case study) 4. Experience as a service business 5. Skills optimization for search

Placeholders: [FREELANCER] Your specialty

■ **Tip:** LinkedIn generates 30-40% of inbound leads for freelancers in B2B niches.

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Prompt #18

Raise Your Rates Email

Write an email to [EXISTING CLIENTS] announcing a rate increase.

You are a freelance pricing coach. Write an email to [EXISTING CLIENTS] announcing a rate increase. Deliver: 1. Timing (30-60 days notice) 2. Framing (value delivered, not apology) 3. New rate announcement 4. Transition options (lock in old rate by X date) 5. Tone that preserves the relationship

■ **Tip:** Rate increases done well strengthen client relationships. Done poorly, they end them. The framing is everything.

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Prompt #19

Client Feedback System

Build a client feedback system for [FREELANCER] to improve service and

You are a quality management specialist. Build a client feedback system for [FREELANCER] to improve service and generate referrals. Deliver: 1. Mid-project check-in (prevents surprises) 2. End-of-project survey (3 questions) 3. How to use negative feedback constructively 4. Turning positive feedback into testimonials 5. Monthly feedback review process

■ **Tip:** Mid-project check-ins catch problems before they become disasters.

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Prompt #20

Content Strategy for Freelancer Authority

Build a content strategy for [FREELANCER] in [NICHE] to attract ideal

You are a content marketing specialist. Build a content strategy for [FREELANCER] in [NICHE] to attract ideal clients. Deliver: Platform selection (2 max) Content pillars (3 topics that attract buyers) Posting frequency Content types that drive DM inquiries 6-week starter calendar

Placeholders: [FREELANCER] Your specialty [NICHE] Target market

■ **Tip:** The freelancers with the strongest content attract inbound leads at 5x the rate of those without.

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Section 5

Section 5 (5 prompts)

Prompt #21

Partnership and Subcontractor Network

Build a partnership and subcontracting network for [FREELANCER].

You are a freelance ecosystem builder. Build a partnership and subcontracting network for [FREELANCER]. Deliver: 1. Complementary skill set mapping 2. How to find and vet partners 3. Revenue share vs referral fee design 4. Subcontractor agreement terms 5. Quality control for subcontracted work

■ **Tip:** A referral partner network turns competitors into collaborators.

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Prompt #22

Discovery to Close: Full Sales Process

Map the complete sales process for [FREELANCER] from first contact to

You are a freelance sales coach. Map the complete sales process for [FREELANCER] from first contact to signed contract. Deliver: Stage 1: Lead qualification (is this a fit?) Stage 2: Discovery call Stage 3: Proposal delivery and follow-up Stage 4: Negotiation Stage 5: Contract and deposit For each stage: What to do, what to say, what not to do

■ **Tip:** Most freelancers lose deals in the follow-up stage. Build a follow-up system.

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Prompt #23

Passive Income for Freelancers

Design passive income streams for [FREELANCER]'s skills in [NICHE].

You are a multiple income stream specialist. Design passive income streams for [FREELANCER]'s skills in [NICHE]. Deliver: Options: Digital products (templates, guides), courses, newsletter, consulting day rates, SaaS, licensing For [FREELANCER'S NICHE]: Top 3 most viable options with build-vs-buy analysis

Placeholders: [FREELANCER'S NICHE] Your specialty

■ **Tip:** Passive income starts with what you already know. Teach or productize your most repeated advice.

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Prompt #24

Working with Agencies as Subcontractor

Create a strategy for [FREELANCER] to get subcontract work from agenci

You are a freelance business strategist. Create a strategy for [FREELANCER] to get subcontract work from agencies. Deliver: 1. Target agency identification 2. Positioning for agencies vs direct clients 3. Agency outreach script 4. White-label work boundaries 5. Rate negotiation with agencies 6. Agency relationship management

■ **Tip:** Agencies can provide consistent work volume without the marketing effort of direct client acquisition.

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Prompt #25

Freelance Business Systems Audit

Audit [FREELANCER]'s business systems and create an optimization plan.

You are a freelance operations specialist. Audit [FREELANCER]'s business systems and create an optimization plan. Deliver: Systems to audit: Lead generation, sales, onboarding, delivery, invoicing, communication, project management For each: Current state, ideal state, gap, 3 improvements

■ **Tip:** A systems audit turns a stressful freelance business into a predictable one.

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